Reflexes useful for breast feeding

- The following two reflexes are helpful for the babies in breast feeding.
- Rooting reflex: To find the nipple and proper attachment to breast.
- Sucking reflex: To draw out milk from mother's breast.

Types of Breast Milk

The breast milk secreted undergoes changes as the days goes on to meet the demands of the baby.

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1	Colostrum	This milk is secreted in the first week of life.Thick and yellow. Rich in protein and antibodies
2	Transitional milk	Milk that is secreted between the 1st and the 2nd week. The fat and sugar content starts increasing.
3	Mature milk	After 2 weeks, the milk secreted is known as mature milk It is thinner and watery Rich in all necessary nutrients



Foremilk vs Hindmilk

The milk that is secreted when the baby initiates feeding is foremilk whereas the milk that is secreted at the end the feed is hindmilk. The foremilk satisfies the thirst of the baby whereas the hindmilk which is high in fat provides satiety.

Techniques of breast feeding

Positioning

- The mother is relaxed and comfortable.
- The baby's head and body are in a straight line
- The baby's face is opposite the nipple and the breast
- The baby's upper lip or nose is opposite the mother's nipple
- The baby is held or supported very close to the mothers body
- The baby's whole body is supported if the mother is in a sitting position

Attachment: It is otherwise known as latching. It means attachment of nipple along with areola in baby's mouth and not nipple alone.

Key points to good attachment

- The mouth is widely open
- The tongue is forward in the mouth, and may be seenover the bottom gum
- The lower lip is turned outwards
- The chin is touching the breast

More areola is visible above the baby's mouth than below it

Burping: After feed the baby should put on to the left shoulder of the mother with its head supported and then with the right arm, the mother should gently pat on the baby's back. It avoids regurgitation.

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